

2c. Content of Exploring poetry and Shakespeare (02)

For this component, learners study a themed poetry cluster from the OCR Poetry Anthology and a Shakespeare play.

There is a choice of three poetry clusters for study, each comprising fifteen poems since 1789, some of which are from the English literary heritage, including Romantic poetry, alongside modern poems and poems from around the world. The poems have been carefully selected to provide a balanced and diverse collection for study.

The focus is on learners taking a skills-based approach to engaging with and responding critically to poetry,

including comparing poems and responding to unseen poetry. Learners explore a Shakespeare play through engaging with key themes and ideas, characterisation and settings. This is underpinned by understanding of the language and how society and culture are presented in the play.

The following tables set out the content of GCSE (9–1) in English Literature, Section A and Section B for component 02. These provide details on the required knowledge, understanding and skills as well as expected breadth and depth of texts studied.

Section A: Exploring poetry and Shakespeare (02)		
Text choice	Content	Learners should be able to:
Poetry across time Choice of one themed poetry cluster from the OCR Poetry Anthology: • Love and Relationships • Conflict • Youth and Age.	There is a choice of three thematic poetry clusters for study in the OCR Poetry Anthology, each comprising a diverse range of poems since 1789 drawn from modern and literary heritage poets and covering different styles, poetic genres and thematic elements. Learners develop comprehension skills. Learners take a skills-based approach to engaging with and responding critically to a variety of poetry. Learners explore how poets use key features to present ideas, themes and settings and learning to differentiate between literal and implied meaning.	reflect critically and evaluatively on their reading. Learners are expected to respond to some of the following: • themes, ideas and issues • atmosphere, tone and attitude • appeal to the senses • language • imagery • form and structure. • pay attention to the details of a text: understanding the significance of a word, phrase or sentence in context • demonstrate the ability to read at a literal level and also explore deeper implications • explain motivation, sequence of events and the relationship between actions or events.

Text choice	Content	Learners should be able to:
Poetry across time	Learners develop critical reading skills. Learners engage personally with their reading and build confidence in their abilities to sustain an individual response to texts which is supported and justified and recognise that there are different interpretations that other readers could make. Learners analyse and evaluate how language, form and structure inform and impact on their reading of poetry. Learners will require knowledge and understanding of grammatical and structural features and literary and linguistic terminology, including (but not restricted to) rhyming pattern, stanza form and imagery in order to support their views about the text with insight and precision. Learners develop their critical and comparative understanding of texts. Learners engage with a range of poems to discover how understanding of one poem is illuminated by its relationship with another. This prepares them for making comparisons between a studied poem from their poetry cluster and a thematically linked unseen poem in the exam.	• identify and interpret key themes • make an informed personal response, justifying a point of view by referring closely to evidence in the text • recognise and evaluate the possibility of different valid responses to a text. • explain and illustrate how vocabulary choices and structural features shape meaning • analyse how the writer uses language (including figurative language), form and structure to create effects and impact • use relevant subject terminology accurately to support their views. • in order to enhance their understanding of themes, settings and literary styles, learners make connections and contrasts between poems, comparing features and qualities.

Text choice	Content	Learners should be able to:
Poetry across time	Learners develop writing skills. Learners make a sustained, informed personal response to their reading. They are able to write effectively about literature for different purposes, including writing to describe, explain, summarise, argue, analyse and evaluate. Learners craft their writing and create impact through careful selection and emphasis of key points, interwoven with textual evidence to back up their understanding and ideas.	• produce clear and coherent pieces of extended writing • select and emphasise key points and ideas for a particular purpose • develop and maintain a consistent viewpoint • use textual references and quotations effectively to support views • use accurate Standard English and spelling, punctuation and grammar.